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FASCISM OUT OF TIME AND OUT OF SYNCH

LATE FASCISM: RACE, CAPITALISM AND THE POLITICS OF CRISIS

BY ALBERTO TOSCANO

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Nominalism and historicism govern most attempts to diagnose the “malaise” of our times. It would not be wrong to consider the proliferation of terminological disputes around terms such as “populism,” “authoritarianism,” and “fascism” as symptomatic of a crisis of conceptualization: conventional paradigms under which events and processes have hitherto been subsumed—not only by more mainstream theorists but also by scholars of the critical tradition—are apparently undergoing severe strain. We seem to have arrived at a critical juncture—a moment of *krisis* (which originally meant “turning point” or “threshold” in Greek)—that warrants exercising discernment and judgment beyond epistemic comfort zones. Reminiscent of the dilemmas of intellectuals of the interwar period, our generation must once again learn to “think without banisters,” as did Hannah Arendt and her contemporaries.

And yet, even this reference to the interwar period may be said to disclose unacknowledged assumptions as to why the conceptual *krisis* transpires. The narrative of progress, the vision of modernity as an “unfinished project,” and normative accounts of liberal democracy’s achievements rely on schematizations that portray the eruption of fascism at the heart of Europe as an aberration, an anomaly. Such historical schemes tend to erase other temporal markers, both within polities hailed as liberal and in their former colonies. Nowhere was this erasure more apparent than in scholarly reactions to Donald Trump’s election as president of the United States in 2016. Trump’s victory

appeared to many as the very trigger that prompted reflection on the extent to which the F-word may accurately depict the sinister trends of the twenty-first century. Others, however, hesitated in categorizing Trump as an exception within the *longue durée* of the capitalist enterprise. This was one of the moments in which the epistemic bias of the bulk of theoretical analyses came under scrutiny. Was Trump the decisive break with the liberal system, considered a bulwark against fascistic encroachments on the institutions of the modern state and the rule of law? Or was his election the foreseeable culmination of a process that was identified and named long before? After all, wasn't Orbán already in power, and so too Putin, Erdoğan, and Modi, when Trump was elected? Weren't critical scholars already pointing to the implosion of liberal checks on power under the weight of the neoliberal consensus: one imposed on the globe by insidious mechanisms of arm-twisting that devised new policing tactics to quash strikes and batter workers in some parts of the world or fomented counter-revolutionary insurgency (and even military coups) as in Chile and Turkey? Wasn't technocratic rationality asphyxiating even the semblance of participatory governance? And going even further back, weren't fascist techniques and ideologies developed and refined through colonial rule and chattel slavery? We cannot speak of a "return," a regression, unless we agree about what period in history we are returning to. While it appears obvious to historians of fascism that trends characterizing the Europe of the 1920s and 1930s are being reiterated today, albeit in farcical ways, Marxist scholars such as Ian Bruff tend to see in this moment a return to specific "capitalist fixes" that predate interwar fascism.¹ Critical race theorists and decolonial scholarship point to practices of domination and racial discrimination that have never disappeared, even in the heyday of liberal democracy. What presumptions led U.S. and European scholars to theorize neoliberalism as a "soft" instrument of de-democratization only to be caught unawares by Trump's ascendance to power? What forms of epistemic blindness produce disregard for signs of systematic violence? There is sufficient reason to believe that the banisters upon which most commentators lean must undergo serious questioning.

As seen from this vantage point, Alberto Toscano's *Late Fascism* is a much welcome intervention. Toscano's central thesis is that today's fascism is "late," not only because it trails behind earlier incarnations

of fascism, from European colonization to Jim Crow, from Bonaparte to Mussolini and Hitler, but that it is also “late” in the sense of being a response to perceived threats of “communism” at a time when class struggle has waned and potentially revolutionary collective subjects are already in disarray. Out of time and out of synch, late fascism nevertheless requires diligent investigation as it necessarily emerges from mutations in capitalism, state structures, and progressive demands.

The book is a collection of essays, written between 2017 and 2022, that reflect upon related yet distinct conceptual underpinnings of fascism. The avowed aim is to provide a “metacommentary” instead of developing a full-fledged theoretical treatise on fascism. Citing Theodor Adorno, Toscano surmises that the latter is untheoretical by nature. He instead proposes to approach fascism as a totality of processes in its *longue durée*, “a dynamic that precedes its naming.” Since fascism is essentially mutable, its extrinsic consistency is to be traced within the prerequisites of capitalist accumulation. Lashing out at historicist checklists but also at superficial analogies between fascisms then and now, Toscano identifies alternative genealogies of elements of fascism, gleaned from a broad variety of thinkers ranging from the Frankfurt School to critical race theorists. While temporality is one line of questioning that disturbs the complacency of approaches to fascism past and present, another fault line that Toscano’s book uncovers concerns the relationship between fascism and the liberal state.

One setback is that the book is contrapuntal and polemical. Neither the organization nor the title of the chapters guide the reader in discerning the various argumentative threads that Toscano follows without systematically tying them together. Chapters 1–2 center on the temporality of fascism, while chapters 3–4 appear as digressions since they settle other accounts (fascism’s relationship to freedom, the liberal state and capitalism). Chapter 5 returns to the question of temporality, spelling out Toscano’s own theses more explicitly this time. Chapter 6 appears once again as a digression, focusing on 1970s strategies of myth making. Chapter 7 reflects on the libidinal and gendered dimension of past and present fascisms. The conclusion leaves us in *krisis* since many of the questions posed throughout the book seem yet to be answered. This having been said, Toscano’s analysis is anything but impressionistic. We are provided with erudite reflections on a heterogeneous fascist topography. A series of contestations points to paths

any theoretical exploration of fascism must take. Toscano vigorously challenges the terms of the historicist debate, which authoritatively limits analogies. His purpose, however, is to go beyond comparisons and analogies. This requires “allowing history and the present to illuminate, but also unsettle, one another” (155). It also entails traversing often contradictory narratives to identify modes of problematization likely to shed light on contemporary predicaments.

Late Fascism starts out by asking whether the present conjuncture warrants close analogies in the first place. The dialectics of class and capital does not suffice to capture the multiple layers of interaction between fascism and capitalism, Toscano contends, demanding instead that we rethink fascism’s relation to time and to the social imaginaries it attempts to divert. Franco “Bifo” Berardi’s attributing Trump’s success to the Left’s neglect of white working-class frustrations provides the context for Toscano to revisit Georges Bataille and Ernst Bloch’s reflections. Both thinkers acknowledge the heterogeneity of temporalities in the interwar period and arrive at a similar diagnosis: fascism activates the unfulfilled pasts and utopian potentials of classes at the margins of capitalist rationality. Toscano argues, nevertheless, that any attempt to portray fascism as “a perverted utopian promise” must now be qualified. Admitting with Adorno that the “authoritarian personality” is a product of the crisis of bourgeois individuality in the postwar context, Toscano proposes that we think of fascism as a play of narcissisms and pseudo-fanaticisms. Late fascism cannot capture utopian energies, since the fascist subject has neither inner convictions, nor any psychic mechanism to transcend the *status quo*. The social structures of late capitalism pose limits to analogy. The burning question of the temporality of twenty-first-century fascism is introduced against this backdrop. Toscano embraces Jairus Banaji’s idea that in the current conjuncture fascism mobilizes by manipulating “postpsychological de-individualized atoms” (16). Instead of group coherence, we have a manipulated series that falls short of constituting a mass movement. Accordingly, there is “no path leading from the false totality of an other-directed racialised class to a renaissance of class politics” (17). The national-populist revolt against “globalism” reveals itself to be nothing but a fake class discourse, replacing the potent mythological discourses of revival of the 1930s with a lackluster nostalgia for the era of industrial production.

Perhaps the book's most cogent section is where Toscano challenges conventional historicist periodization with the help of critical race theorists. Drawing on a host of thinkers (Cedric Robinson, Aimée Césaire, W. E. B. Du Bois, Angela Davis, and George Jackson among others), Toscano disputes the Western epistemic paradigm that construes fascism as an aberration: "Long before Nazi violence came to be conceived as beyond comparison, Black radical thinkers sought to expand the historical and political imagination of an anti-fascist left" (28). The central argument is that colonial and racial fascism not only predates Nazism, but that the so-called boomerang effect would need to be rethought today. Proposing a Gestalt switch, Toscano suggests that we look into the differential racial dynamics of the U.S. carceral state to grasp how new forms of fascism are generated from the very bosom of the liberal world rather than being boomeranged out toward it from its colonial past. Shifting the emphasis on state and capitalist violence rather than far-right movements would lead us to acknowledge how in the United States, "racialized rightlessness" is the norm and not the exception. "Rightlessness" is one of the terms of the "oppressive contract" premised on white supremacy. Davis's scalding critique of prisons as racialized laboratories for fascist strategies enables Toscano to argue that "racial carceral fascism" is anchored in liberal political economy. Rather than being the opposite of liberalism, fascism is deployed for its restoration in the face of capitalism's crises. Differential fascism in zones of internal exclusion (prisons, ghettos) and sites of exception (the frontier, the colony, state of emergency) is the doppelganger of liberal democracy. But racial fascism goes unremarked upon even by left-wing thinkers because of the color line. The antifascist Left is guilty of the "methodological conceit" that consists of whitewashing both liberalism and neoliberalism. This amounts to severing "actually existing neoliberalism from its imbrication with the changing imperatives of racial capitalism and with reconfigurations of the racial state into an 'anti-state state'" (46). Also held to task is the Left's current conceptual impasse, caught as it is between a fascism without fascists or else fascists without fascism. Conceiving of actually existing liberal democracies through the notion of "incipient fascism" (Marcuse; Davis) and remembering Nicos Poulantzas's admonition that incoherence is the strength of fascism would suffice to overcome the Left's theoretical conundrums, Toscano

suggests. The espousal of neoliberalism can go hand-in-hand with an aversion to globalism and a conservative nostalgia for the industrialized past. Fascism today is not a reaction to actually existing revolutionary classes; it obeys an anticipatory logic. Aware of the weakness of the opposition, it enacts a preventative counter-revolution.

This compelling and indispensable corrective to mainly Western theoretizations of fascism is complemented by a preemptive move to ward off objections concerning the status and role of the state in fascism. Having argued that postwar liberalism was implicated in fascist practices, Toscano's objective is to show that the liberal state cannot be construed as the opposite of fascism—as the target of its destructive thrust—in the 1930s either. The Italian fascists, we are told, intended to restore to the state its classical liberal “nightwatchman” function, equipped with a bludgeon, to protect it from degenerating into socialism. Toscano's claim is primarily based on textual and ideational support: Mussolini and Gentile are quoted as hailing liberty and declaring war on class war in view of massive privatization. The waters are troubled when the liberty that Italian fascism and Nazism espoused is almost put on par with emancipatory notions of freedom. If we were to admit, with Johann Chapoutot, that fascist freedom consisted in a performative and “racial spontaneity capable of creating its own immanent right or law” (59), we would need to account for how spontaneity can be “racialized” without impinging on that very spontaneity. Although Toscano faults Arendt for not recognizing “freedom's racial over-determinations,” a few pages later he equates fascist visions of freedom with the “freedom to dominate, to rule” (73) or the “freedom to obey” (76). These are, of course, anathema to freedom in its Arendtian sense of the incalculable and unforeseeable capacity of unique beings to make a new beginning. If fascist “freedom,” conceived as bestial spontaneity or “acquiescent license” (Herbert Marcuse) merits theorization, then more space must be devoted to decoupling the figure of the petty sovereign from that of the Communiardi or the transgressive pleasures that Toscano evokes when discussing neoliberal-fascistic forms of empowerment from collective freedoms. On a side note, Slavoj Žižek's polemical formulation, according to which the Holocaust is an abyssimally free albeit monstrous decision, appears more of a challenge in terms of the concept of freedom than what we are asked to reflect on in *Late Fascism*.²

Toscano's contestation of the prevalent assumption—as well as the Cold War propagandist slogan—that fascism erects a totalitarian state stands on much sturdier ground. Instead of taking Carl Schmidt or Mussolini at face value, Toscano argues that the fascist machine must be construed as a nonstate, a Behemoth instead of a Leviathan, “whose performance is measured by its efficiency” (63). Fascism operates a *de facto* abolition of the modern state and law as transcendent instances, but it is not for that reason totally spontaneous. The flexibility of the shapeless administrative apparatus allows it to adjust to the shifting composition of ruling groups as well as to their expansionist vision. This claim, buttressed by Franz Neumann and Marcuse's writings on Nazism, prompts Toscano to further tackle the question of neoliberalism's relation to the state. Once again refusing to accept its apologists at face value, Toscano suggests that neoliberalism strengthens rather than weakens the state. The state is invested with the new mission of creating and fortifying the disciplinary mechanisms of the market. Unlike most theorists on the Left, Toscano brings racism once more into the picture so as to urge more attention be paid to the differential reinforcement of state domination in the neoliberal era. Ruth Gilmore's concept of “anti-state state” becomes an ally on this score: this paradoxical formation consists of “a state that promises its own demise and which employs that promise to increase, intensify and differentiate its capacities, its powers” (67). The naturalization of violence is essential to neoliberalize the state's capacities and neutralize the contradictions between state and society. Mass incarceration (mainly of African Americans in the U.S. context) accompanies the drive to privatize. Racial domination is thereby naturalized and moralized. Such authoritarian measures are necessary in order to promote a possessive (and racialized) conception of freedom that is as populist as it is undemocratic.

As to capitalism's intrinsic racism, Toscano deploys the notion of real abstractions to explain why the fascist mentality, although characterized by a hatred of intellectual abstractions (freedom, right, law), nevertheless constructs abstract entities such as “Judeo-Bolshevism” and the “German *Volk*.” According to this line of thought, the classical Marxist critique of reification is not enough to reveal how fascist mystification works. Correcting the “undialectical relation” that Frankfurt School thinkers establish between “real abstractions” such as the

commodity form or money form and anti-Semitism, Toscano traces the post-1950s penchant for fascism in the reconciliation of two forms of cognition characterizing the authoritarian personality: the misplaced abstractness of stereotypy and the misplaced concreteness of personalization (86). These are ersatz forms of knowledge and experience of the world. For Adorno as well as for Norbert Guterman and Henri Lefebvre, “the explanation of the apotropaic appeal of fascist ideology centres on how the psychological burden of systemic opacity is displaced, plugged up, by the fascist solution” (91). Capitalist power, operating through real abstractions, is impersonal, opaque, and phantom-like. Its violence lies in the disposessions it effectuates. Fascist “stereopathy” projects the alienness of capitalism onto people or social groups. “In late fascism, stereotypy and personalisation converge, aided and abetted by algorithmic architectures,” Toscano writes (86).

But even if we admit that today’s fascism (with its pre- and post-1930s imbrications in capitalism’s shifting modalities) is a continuum, we would need to distinguish between specifically fascist instances and bourgeois/colonial ones. This, in Toscano’s view, requires a complex process of periodization involving three distinct temporal analyses. Toscano suggests that we first seek to delineate the characteristics of the time *for* fascism. This refers to objective crisis conjunctures that nevertheless require remaining attuned to potential incongruities in the multiple temporalities involved. Second, we must inquire into the time *in* fascism, which refers to the subjective perceptions of time by fascists themselves. Lastly, the time *of* fascism requires an analysis of various objective and subjective temporalities that fascism mobilizes. These, Toscano hopes, will “offer a privileged prism for thinking through fascism’s novel mutations and materialisations in the present” (97). Rather than drawing up hasty checklists from the 1930s, construing fascism’s historicity as mutable enables Toscano to seek to dethrone the Italian and Nazi examples. The gist of the argument is that fascism intervenes in moments of crises provoked by processes of uneven capitalist accumulation. It mediates between “the time of accumulation (the time of value)” and “the time of resentment or revanchism (the time of identity, and indeed of race)” (111). This portrayal proscribes conceiving of fascism as a regression; it must rather be conceptualized as a flight forward. Fascism is but a mode of salvaging modernity’s own temporal form under the guise of the recovery of a

glorious past: “If fascism can be captured as the organised desire for a ‘capitalism without capitalism’, then it is crucially a capitalism that disavows capitalist temporality, covering over the time of the commodity with that of spiritual revolution, the time of turnover with that of racial-national rebirth” (109). Toscano’s take on the latter engages a surprising culprit: Martin Heidegger. In the latter’s concept of “anticipatory resoluteness,” Toscano detects the fascist marriage between fate and futurity: history is what is to come, and the nation to salvage is that of the future. Through inventive amalgamations, fascism repeats the past *with a difference*. It either accelerates capitalist temporalities toward total war or decelerates them through a hyper-reactionary conservatism. Its incoherence and “super-relativity” are not postmodern, but modern through and through.

The two final chapters focus on debates of the 1970s on the right and left. Toscano first attempts to answer the question of why today’s reactions are framed as cultural. Italian Germanist and mythologist Furio Jesi becomes the primary interlocutor on this score—which, it must be said, is a curious choice since Victor Klemperer, Alexandre Koyré, and Jean-Pierre Faye have lengthily inquired into the language of fascism, arriving at similar conclusions.³ It appears that Toscano wants us to engage directly with an ideologue’s texts to drive in the message that right-wing language is formally esoteric. Jesi is quite explicit in vindicating the strategy of conveying “ideas without words.” What matters is the closed circulation of a “secret” between the speaker and the audience. This is a reprise of the Spenglerian notion of “words without ideas.” Language is not rationally comprehended, but emotionally grasped: it invokes sacrificial logics whereby defeat spells victory (“winning by dying”) and exhorts followers to commit useless acts of violence. The past is (re)presented as a dedifferentiated “value,” which is fetishized as culture. It is like “baby food,” easy to swallow and circulate. Toscano underscores that race is the quintessential “idea without words,” the heart of sacrificial mythological machine. All this is well taken (although not particularly new), but it is a bit frustrating to be given the lone male mass shooter as the only example, mentioned in passing, of how that sacrificial machine sets people into motion. We are left to wonder why and how this chapter contributes to our understanding of the effects of late fascism’s rhetorical devices. The latter are much more vividly illustrated in neofascist practices influenced by

alt-right thinkers such as Alain de Benoist and Daniel Friberg with whom Toscano does not engage at all.⁴

Hopefully not as an afterthought, the last chapter is devoted to fascism's entanglements with Eros and gender. Toscano introduces the matter via 1970s debates on the spectacular and sexualized visibility of a certain kind of cultural fascism (for instance, the cinematography of Pier Paolo Pasolini). Intervening in these debates, Michel Foucault is initially inclined to de-eroticize fascism but later rectifies his position: fascism does not consist solely of repressive or collective death instincts, but must be rethought in its desirability. Gilles Deleuze and Felix Guattari join Foucault in attributing an erotic charge to fascist power and call for an analysis of the micropolitics of desire. Citing studies on the libidinal infrastructure of fascism, Toscano agrees, but warns against the unchecked use of psychoanalysis. He is more interested in how capitalist interests are articulated to fascist desires, on the one hand, and how to make sense of the attractiveness of fascism for women, on the other. He points out that the latter conundrum constituted a blind spot in feminism until Maria Antonietta Macciocchi kindled the debate in the 1970s. Toscano acknowledges Macciocchi's analyses but subjects them to critical interrogation: Do women undergo an expropriation in fascism, owing to a biopolitics of reproduction and a sacrificial politics of death (their sons and husbands being sent to the front) as Macciocchi claims? Or does fascism invent a new racialized sexual politics? Dagmar Herzog is mobilized to complicate the analysis. Despite its pragmatic moral conservatism, the verdict is that fascism accelerated modern sexual trends under a racist cloak. The difference between conservatism and fascism is that the latter never contends with putting bodies back into their place. Toscano finds that this resonates with the fascisation of sex today. With Robyn Marasco and Andrea Dworkin, he draws attention to online misogyny and to the great replacement thesis as a means of controlling women's sexuality, subsisting alongside the regressive empowerment of women through the encouragement of transgressive pleasures, masculine affects, and have-it-all lures. A female anti-feminism has sprung up and so too a "petro-masculinity" harboring an aggressive nostalgia for maleness, motoring, and industrial capitalism, which is aggravated by climate change discourse. Late fascism is both a libidinal proposition and a sex/gender panic, fomenting

“uncivil wars” (152). Gender ideology and transness are nemeses: they facilitate the globalization of a new-right panic that projects macro troubles onto the micro scale of gender. In short, current fascist temporalities, while being marked by lateness and incipience, deploy a form of preventative counter-reform (against gender ideology, critical race theory, and against a nonexistent threat of communism) without becoming as “revolutionary” as fascisms of the past. Unfortunately, though, the gendered aspect of fascism remains unconnected to the book’s lengthy discussion of race and capitalism, although Toscano notes that gender nonconformity cements a new fascist international.⁵

One is tempted to say that, although this is fascinating and commendable reading as well as an erudite exploration of the alternative genealogies of fascism, the book’s span is too broad to be treated in a loosely knit collection of essays. Three major issues stand out as inconclusive. First, Toscano directs us to what he calls the eclectic fallacy: “Because fascism is a scavenger ideology cobbling together available ideological elements, there is a temptation to treat each of those elements (rather than the specificity of each element’s incorporation and articulation into a broader ensemble) as itself fascist or proto-fascist” (145). Regrettably, the charge can be directed at Toscano himself. Without a more systematic effort to connect threads and flesh out arguments, the elements presented in distinct chapters do not actually articulate a “broader ensemble.” For instance, one is left wondering how real abstraction (ch. 4) relates to the libidinal or gendered dimensions of fascism (ch. 7). What “intermediary class position” do women occupy? Or how do neoliberal societies, portrayed by Toscano as manipulated series devoid of group coherence (ch. 1), produce mechanisms that cement not only national but also international alliances around racialized and sexualized panics? Absent the thesis that there is an intrinsic—and not merely accidental or accessory—relationship between capitalism, race, gender/sexuality and fascism, Toscano’s final diagnosis—“contemporary fascist potentials converge and crystallise into forms of ‘border fascism,’” including the borders between genders and sexes—remains sketchy. And doesn’t the empowerment alluded to in the final chapter require a more systematic investigation of the type of power wielded by micro- and macro-elements of fascism in our day?

The second issue relates precisely to this: If fascism is not merely repressive but also productive, and if it mobilizes masses by promising power rather than material gains or convictions, what kind of power is this? Agreeing with Foucault that analyzing fascism requires a micro-physics of power, Toscano argues that fascism requires not the centralization but rather the liberalization and privatization of violence. At the end of the day, fascists do not merely manipulate perceived or real anxieties but are positively empowering. A very specific organization of power is the distinctive mark of fascism, irrespective of the ideas or myths of rebirth that circulate to mobilize the masses. Fascism is not a dictatorship, since the monopoly of violence and power is delegated, turning every “little man” into an “enterprising petty sovereign,” as Toscano shows. The question, however, is whether Toscano makes good of this insight. Because if this is actually the case (and there is sufficient reason to believe so), then we cannot but admit that the state is totalized in a very peculiar way. Ordinary citizens are vested with police power, and every petty sovereign reproduces the state *ad infinitum*. In Arendt, whose analysis follows Neumann’s, the term “totalitarian” denotes the totalization of the murderous functions of Behemoth.

Pace Zizek, Hardt and Negri, and other Marxist scholars, I would contend that totalitarianism is not to be dismissed as a conceptual tool.⁶ Lumping Arendt together in the same basket as demagogues who deploy totalitarianism in order to sing the praise of liberalism is not only an irresponsible but also a sloppy reading of her work. That certain aspects of Stalin’s rule can be subsumed under that very category is not a sufficient reason to rebuff it altogether, especially if we want to shun the facile depiction of fascism as a capitalist fix. Toscano dismisses the term because he exclusively anchors fascism’s genealogy in capitalism. He thus deprives himself of a means to account for totalizing tendencies, either of the past or of the contemporary era.⁷ The impersonal, opaque, and phantom-like dispossessions effectuated by nominally socialist regimes or that cut across the Left-Right ideological divide escape his radar and thereby end up being disculpated from the charge of having failed to provide viable alternatives to capitalism and from having paradoxically mimicked some of fascism’s repressive reflexes and mystifications.

Lastly, Toscano espouses the task that Foucault spells out for progressive intellectuals, namely, “to make detectable and intolerable

those latent and tolerated forms of fascism that lurk beneath the social threshold of recognition" (138). There is no doubt that *Late Fascism* splendidly accomplishes the task of detection. The book is both thought-provoking and unsettling. But does it make fascism intolerable? To some degree, yes, but this begs for so much more.

Zeynep Gambetti is an independent scholar, who taught as associate professor of political theory at Bogazici University until 2019. Her theoretical work focuses on contemporary forms of violence and resistance. Among her publications are *Rhetorics of Insecurity: Belonging and Violence in the Neoliberal Era* (co-edited with Marcial Godoy-Anativia) and *Vulnerability in Resistance: Politics, Feminism, Theory* (co-edited with Judith Butler and Leticia Sabsay).

Notes

1. See Bruff 2014.
2. The exact formulation in *Did Somebody Say Totalitarianism?* is the following: "What is to be added after we have explored all the historical, etc., circumstances of the Holocaust is simply the abyss of the act itself: of the free *decision*, in all its monstrosity" (66).
3. Cf. Klemperer; Koyré; Fay.
4. For the "words without ideas" that gave birth to the New Right in Europe (euphemistically called the alt-right in the U.S.), see de Benoît; Friberg.
5. Notice that the book's subtitle, "Race, Capitalism and the Politics of Crisis" tellingly leaves gender out.
6. Hardt and Negri, 421, n.9, go as far as to write that the "numerous shelves of our libraries that are filled with analyses of totalitarianism should be regarded only with shame and thrown away with no hesitation." For an immanent critique of their dismissal cf. Gambetti and Güremen.
7. I expand this analysis in "Exploratory Notes on the Origins of New Fascisms."

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